PMBOK / PMI | PMB-21

Risk Management Plan

How risk will be identified, analysed, responded to and monitored

Meridian Group

Programme Helios — Infrastructure and Platform Stack for AI GPU Compute at Scale

Field	Detail
Document title	Risk Management Plan
Document reference	*PMB-21-HEL-T2-v1.0*
Project / Programme	*Helios Tranche 2 — Scale Build*
Version	*1.0*
Status	*Baselined*
Date	*18 Sep 2026*
Author	*D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager*
Owner	*Project manager*
Approver	*Sponsor*
Classification	*Internal*
Retention	*7 years from programme closure*

Document control

Version history

Version	Date	Author	Summary of change
0.1	*04 Jun 2026*	*D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager*	*Initial draft*
0.2	*21 Jul 2026*	*D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager*	*Updated following workstream lead review*
1.0	*18 Sep 2026*	*D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager*	*Baselined at the Tranche 2 funding gate*

Reviewers

Name	Role	Review scope	Date reviewed
T. Nakamura, Chief Platform Architect	*Chief Platform Architect*	*Technical content and solution alignment*	*08 Sep 2026*
L. Haddad, CISO	*CISO*	*Security, assurance and residency content*	*10 Sep 2026*
C. Whitfield, Finance Business Partner	*Finance Business Partner*	*Cost, funding and benefit figures*	*11 Sep 2026*
M. Verity, Head of P3O	*Head of P3O*	*Governance standards and completeness*	*15 Sep 2026*

Approval

This product is baselined once approval is recorded below. Any subsequent change must go through change control.

Name	Role	Decision	Date
R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	*Senior Responsible Owner / Group CTO*	*Approved*	*18 Sep 2026*
H. Farrell, Director of Infrastructure	*Director of Infrastructure*	*Approved*	*18 Sep 2026*
L. Haddad, CISO	*CISO*	*Approved subject to closure of ISS-003*	*18 Sep 2026*

Related products

Reference	Product	Relationship
PMB-22	Risk Register and Risk Report	Produced under this plan
PMB-15	Cost Estimates and Basis of Estimates	Contingency derives from risk analysis
P2-06	Risk Management Approach	PRINCE2 equivalent

How to use this template

Aspect	Guidance
Purpose	Defines how risk management will be structured and performed — the methodology, roles, budget, timing, risk categories, probability and impact definitions, tolerances and reporting formats.
Framework	PMBOK / PMI — Risk Management — Plan Risk Management
Created when	During planning
Reviewed / updated	At each phase boundary
Owner	Project manager
Approver	Sponsor
Format options	Document, presentation, register entry, or tool record — the content matters, not the medium.
Tailoring	The probability and impact scales must be calibrated to this project. Scales copied from another project produce scores that mean nothing.

This is a worked example. Every field has been completed with illustrative content for Programme Helios, a fictional AI GPU infrastructure and platform programme. All example content is shown in grey italic — the black text is the template itself. Replace the grey italic content with your own.

Quality criteria

Use these to check the product is fit for purpose before submitting it for approval.

- Probability and impact scales are defined in project-specific terms with numeric ranges
- Risk appetite and thresholds are stated by the sponsor, not assumed
- Risk categories reflect the actual risk landscape, including security and regulatory categories where relevant
- Roles are named and the time commitment for risk activities is realistic
- Opportunity is addressed as well as threat

Contents

1. Risk management approach

Methodology, tools and data sources used.

Delivery is phased into three tranches, each ending with a formal review and a funding gate. Facilities and hardware workstreams follow a predictive approach with design freeze points, because their lead times and physical dependencies do not tolerate emerging requirements. The platform, MLOps and security workstreams run on a quarterly planning interval with an Agile Release Train, because their requirements are genuinely emergent and the feedback loop from researchers is short.

2. Roles and responsibilities

Role	Risk responsibility	Time commitment
Sponsor	Sets risk appetite; owns risks above project tolerance	*R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO*
Project manager	Owns the process; maintains the register	*D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager*
Risk owners	Manage assigned risks and report status	*No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance*
Action owners	Execute agreed responses	*D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager*
Specialists	Provide expert assessment in their domain	*Developer pushes to the platform monorepo; pre-commit hooks run secret scanning*

3. Timing and cadence

Activity	Frequency	Participants	Output
Risk identification workshop	*No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance*	*Helios AI Platform ART*	*No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance*
Risk review	*No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance*	*Helios AI Platform ART*	*No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance*
Quantitative analysis	*Monthly*	*Helios AI Platform ART*	*Hall A accepted at 1,024 GPUs with acceptance certificate*
Risk reporting	*No individual risk*	*Helios AI Platform ART*	*No individual risk may remain*

Activity	Frequency	Participants	Output
	may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance		*above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance*

4. Risk categories

A risk breakdown structure. Include the categories that matter in your context — security, regulatory and supplier risk are commonly under-represented.

Category	Sub-category	Typical sources
Technical	*Handled through the Agile Release Train rather than the predictive workstreams*	*Programme SharePoint — Helios / Tranche 2 / Governance*
External	*Confirmed with the FM provider under the existing facilities contract*	*ALM tool — Helios ART board*
Organisational	*Group Technology — Infrastructure and Platform*	*Group Technology — Infrastructure and Platform*
Project management	*WS6 Security and compliance*	*ALM tool — Helios ART board*
Security	*Escalated to the Portfolio Board where it exceeds programme tolerance*	*ALM tool — Helios ART board*
Regulatory and compliance	*Maintained by the P3O as part of the assurance evidence library*	*Assurance evidence pack, Tranche 2 gate*
Supplier	*Cordant Assurance*	*ALM tool — Helios ART board*

5. Probability scale

Score	Descriptor	Range	Guidance
5	Almost certain	>80%	*Any deviation requires a recorded waiver accepted by the CISO with a stated expiry*
4	Likely	61–80%	*Reviewed at each end-of-tranche review and updated by change control only*
3	Possible	41–60%	*Delegated to the Programme Manager within tolerance; above tolerance to the Programme Board*
2	Unlikely	21–40%	*Any deviation requires a recorded waiver accepted by the CISO with a stated expiry*

Score	Descriptor	Range	Guidance
1	Rare	≤20%	*Reviewed at each end-of-tranche review and updated by change control only*

6. Impact scale

Calibrate the cost and time columns to this project's size. A generic scale is worthless.

Score	Descriptor	Cost	Time	Quality / scope	Reputation / compliance
5	Severe	*AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation*	*2 hours*	*In scope: the physical infrastructure in DXB-1 halls A and B, the compute and storage estate, the network fabric, the orchestration and scheduling platform, the MLOps and developer experience layer, the security controls required for multi-tenancy, and the operational readiness required to run the estate. Out of scope: the models themselves, business-unit data engineering, the AUH-2 second site (Tranche 3), and any change to the existing corporate WAN.*	*Agreed with the integration partner at design freeze, 15 Oct 2026*
4	Major	*AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation*	*90 days*	*In scope: the physical infrastructure in DXB-1 halls A and B, the compute and storage estate, the network fabric, the orchestration and scheduling platform, the MLOps and developer experience layer, the security controls required for multi-tenancy, and the operational readiness required to run the estate. Out of scope: the models themselves, business-unit data engineering, the AUH-2 second site (Tranche 3), and any*	*Enforced automatically in the delivery pipeline, with evidence retained*

Score	Descriptor	Cost	Time	Quality / scope	Reputation / compliance
				change to the existing corporate WAN.	
3	Moderate	*AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation*	*90 days*	*In scope: the physical infrastructure in DXB-1 halls A and B, the compute and storage estate, the network fabric, the orchestration and scheduling platform, the MLOps and developer experience layer, the security controls required for multi-tenancy, and the operational readiness required to run the estate. Out of scope: the models themselves, business-unit data engineering, the AUH-2 second site (Tranche 3), and any change to the existing corporate WAN.*	*Maintained by the P3O as part of the assurance evidence library*
2	Minor	*AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation*	*2 hours*	*In scope: the physical infrastructure in DXB-1 halls A and B, the compute and storage estate, the network fabric, the orchestration and scheduling platform, the MLOps and developer experience layer, the security controls required for multi-tenancy, and the operational readiness required to run the estate. Out of scope: the models themselves, business-unit data engineering, the AUH-2 second site (Tranche 3), and any change to the existing corporate WAN.*	*Reflected in the solution intent as a fixed constraint*
1	Negligible	*AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before*	*2 hours*	*In scope: the physical infrastructure in DXB-1 halls A and B, the compute and storage estate, the network*	*Delegated to the Programme Manager within the agreed tolerance*

Score	Descriptor	Cost	Time	Quality / scope	Reputation / compliance
		escalation		*fabric, the orchestration and scheduling platform, the MLOps and developer experience layer, the security controls required for multi-tenancy, and the operational readiness required to run the estate. Out of scope: the models themselves, business-unit data engineering, the AUH-2 second site (Tranche 3), and any change to the existing corporate WAN.*	

7. Risk tolerance and escalation

Score range	Rating	Response required	Owner	Escalation
20–25	Extreme	Immediate action; escalate on identification	*D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager*	*To the Programme Manager within one working day; to the SRO within three*
12–19	High	Response plan required; reviewed fortnightly	*D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager*	*To the Programme Manager within one working day; to the SRO within three*
6–11	Medium	Response plan required; reviewed monthly	*D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager*	*To the Programme Manager within one working day; to the SRO within three*
1–5	Low	Monitor	*D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager*	*To the Programme Manager within one working day; to the SRO within three*

8. Response strategies

Threat strategies	Opportunity strategies
Escalate — outside project authority	Escalate — outside project authority
Avoid — eliminate the cause	Exploit — make it certain
Transfer — shift to a third party	Share — partner to increase likelihood

Threat strategies	Opportunity strategies
Mitigate — reduce probability or impact	Enhance — increase probability or impact
Accept — take no action, monitor	Accept — take no action, monitor

9. Risk budget

Item	Amount	Basis
Contingency reserve	*AED 91,200,000*	*2,048 units including 5-year vendor support*
Cost of response actions	*AED 17,800,000*	*12 PB usable, 1.2 TB/s sustained*
Risk management process cost	*AED 13,600,000*	*400G leaf-spine, optics and structured cabling*